DAY 35 · THEORY HANDOUT

Check RAG Answers and Summaries

Test retrieval, evidence, missing answers, and short document reports.

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The idea and its useful terms

Test retrieval, evidence, missing answers, and short document reports.

Test question

A fixed question with an expected source fact.

Retrieval check

Did search return the needed evidence?

Answer check

Did the answer match that evidence?

One good answer can hide weak search. A small set of known questions helps us find which stage caused a mistake.

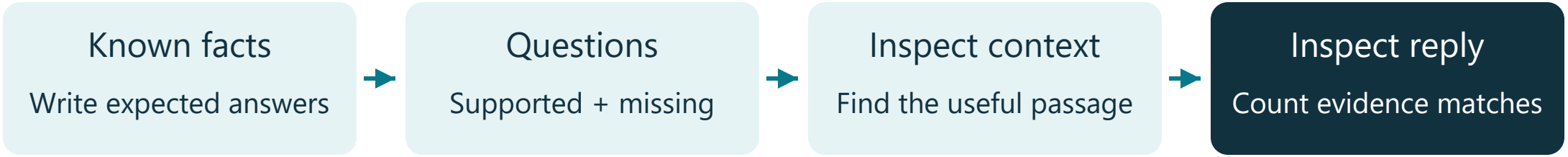
A summary needs broad coverage; a question needs a particular fact. The same top-k setting may not suit both jobs.

> Check missing-answer questions as well as easy ones. An honest unknown is better than an invented detail.

Follow the work, one step at a time

Each step has a job. We can inspect its output before moving on.

Read the path from left to right.



Each arrow means: pass the result to the next step.

For each test question, keep an expected source fact. First check that retrieval found that fact. Then check that the answer states it correctly. This separates a search mistake from a reply mistake.

A word match is a quick signal, not a complete evaluation. A summary also needs coverage and no added facts. For a long report, summarize pieces, then merge and check the final report against the pieces.

> If the answer is wrong, inspect the input and the intermediate results. The last sentence alone cannot show which step failed.

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A small example we can check

The values here are classroom examples. The notebook shows actual results.

Question A

Python time?

Expected: Monday 10:00.

Question B

Pandas time?

Expected: Tuesday 11:00.

Question C

Course fee?

Expected: not provided.

Read the given input first. Point to the fact or value needed for the requested output.

Run the matching example, then try the fresh input at the end of the notebook. Compare both results with the known input.

> Check missing-answer questions as well as easy ones. An honest unknown is better than an invented detail.

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Choose the setting or tool for its job

A different choice changes the work. These are the choices we compare.

Q&A

Retrieve a focused passage.

Answer a narrow question.

Summary

Read all short sections.

Keep main points.

Long report

Summarize pieces first.

Check the final merge.

Run the fixed three-question table and keep the actual outputs.

Check retrieval separately from the final answer. Do not call a word match a full quality score.

> Summarize all short notes, then check each bullet against its source section.

Practice, check, and read the full lesson

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Use the notebook to try the steps. Use the article when you need the longer explanation.

1. Build

Run the small example.

Inspect each step.

2. Change

Try the fresh input.

Keep the goal clear.

3. Check

Compare with the source.

Keep mistakes visible.

Summarize all short notes, then check each bullet against its source section.

Read the complete tutorial breakdown for this section in our KGP Talkie article.

> Check missing-answer questions as well as easy ones. An honest unknown is better than an invented detail.

DAY 35 · COMPLETE

Thank You

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